

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

TUESDAY, AUGUST 19, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Ukraine talks come to White House

Trump meets with Zelenskyy, phones Putin for next step

By Josh Boak and Samya Kullab
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Monday he has begun arrangements for a face-to-face meeting between Vladimir Putin and Volodymyr Zelenskyy to discuss a pathway to end Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

The president made the

announcement shortly after speaking by phone with Putin on Monday even as he hosted Zelenskyy and top European leaders to discuss his push to end the war.

"I called President Putin, and began the arrangements for a meeting, at a location to be determined, between President Putin and President Zelenskyy," Trump said in a social media post soon after his meetings with Zelenskyy and European leaders ended. "After that meeting takes place, we will have a Trilat, which would be the two Presidents, plus myself. Again, this was a very good, early step for a War that has been going

on for almost four years."

It's not clear if Putin has fully signed on to such talks.

Russia state news agency Tass cited Putin's foreign affairs adviser Yuri Ushakov saying Putin and Trump "spoke in favor" of continuing direct talks between the Russian and Ukrainian delegations. Ushakov said they also discussed "the idea of raising the level of the direct Russian-Ukrainian negotiations."

Earlier, Trump said during talks with Zelenskyy and European leaders that a potential ceasefire

Turn to Ukraine, Page 9



President Donald Trump greets Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy Monday in Washington. **JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP**

La Grange eliminates honorary street name

Namesake's daughter alleges he sexually abused her as child

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

For the past half-century, a tree-lined stretch of 48th Street in La Grange was named Linklater Court in memory of the west suburb's longtime village attorney William John Linklater, who died in 1971.

Yet the La Grange Village Board recently stripped the street of this honorary moniker after the late lawyer's daughter accused him of sexually abusing her as a child during a stunning public comment session at a Village Board meeting.

Anne Brandt, 79, at a late June meeting, implored village officials to remove the street's honorary name, alleging her father had sexually abused her as a child during the 1950s.

"I am the daughter of William Linklater for whom the street is named. William Linklater groomed me and sexually abused me from when I was approximately 5 years old until I was 10 years old in our home," Brandt told the Village Board. "For the village of La Grange to change Linklater Court back to its original name of 48th Street would be an outward sign that La Grange does not ... honor pedophiles. It would be a sign that this current board recognizes the rights of the injured...the innocents and those without a voice."

At least one family member, however, disputes Brandt's claims of abuse.

Erin Linklater Palumbo, a granddaughter of the late village attorney, said in an email to the Tribune that "the family vocif-

Turn to Linklater, Page 4



The Cruz family, Delia, Ivan and their children Leo, 12, Lionel, 11, Jadelinn, 8, and Jayne, 5, walk from their home to Edward Sadlowski Elementary School in Chicago on Monday for the first day of school. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Excitement amid cuts

Families and community face first day of school during CPS financial uncertainty

By Nell Salzman and Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Across the city Monday morning, children stepped into crisp uniforms and laced up brand-new shoes for the first day of school. Yellow buses wove through neighborhoods on soon-to-be familiar routes. Parents hugged their little ones and wished them well with their new teachers and friends.

Despite the first day buzz,

Chicago Public Schools opened its school doors amid a time of serious financial uncertainty, felt most by the parents and community interacting with the district every day.

Delia Cruz, 37, a CPS mom from the East Side, doesn't begrudge the district for being under-resourced, but as schools face tight budgets, she has learned how to be a fierce advocate for her kids.

"I'm not doing it for me, I'm doing it for them," she said, as she braided her 8-year-old daughter

Jadelinn's hair into tight coils Monday morning in her living room before their morning commute.

In the months leading up to Monday, CPS officials were focused on closing a \$734 million budget deficit — all while navigating a power struggle fueled by a monthslong conflict between City Hall, the Chicago Teachers Union and district leadership. Over the summer, CPS released school-level budgets, the financial road maps that guide spending at indi-

vidual schools. Principals spent hours adjusting operational planning based on the allocations they received.

According to a CPS news release, the district allocates resources based on specific student needs and school programs — including services for English language learners, students with disabilities and those requiring social and emotional support.

Turn to School, Page 2

Texas Democrats return to home state

Texas House Democrats returned to their state Monday after spending two weeks in the Chicago area and other parts of the country to prevent the Republican majority in their legislature from passing a new gerrymandered congressional map aimed at eliminating five Democratic seats. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Construction underway on O'Hare terminal

After years of negotiations and delays, construction is underway on the first of several major projects that represent a massive overhaul at O'Hare International Airport. Construction started in earnest last month on what will become the airport's new Concourse D. **Business**

Father's attempt to stand up for daughter ends in death



Latisha McMillen holds a photo of her and her husband, Eric McMillen, on May 6. Eric McMillen was allegedly killed by their daughter's boyfriend. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Longtime family friend charged with his killing

By Caroline Kubzansky
Chicago Tribune

Latisha McMillen stood in the doorway of the crowded closet she shared with her husband and put her face into a folded white T-shirt. She took a deep breath into the fabric, sighed and put it back on a stack of shoeboxes. She kicked another, empty box.

"These had the shoes he died in," she said that day. "I'm waiting for (the morgue) to give them back."

Eric McMillen's black and gray sneakers with orange accents and leopard print laces never did get returned. Latisha McMillen couldn't stand to look at her own matching pair, which sat untouched in their closet.

But getting dressed Monday morning, Latisha felt the need to

Turn to Death, Page 5

